Ishkhan Khchoian

Product Manager — 0-to-1, discovery & delivery

Yerevan, Armenia · remote, or on-site / hybrid in Yerevan · open to relocation
+374 98 60 34 64 · ishxanxchoyan@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/ishkhan-khchoian-2419182b3
English (C1) · Russian (native) · Armenian (native)

PROFILE

I am currently COO of **SayWhen.am**, an early-stage startup building AI voice agents that handle inbound and outbound business calls — natural conversation instead of phone menus, multilingual, integrated with a client's CRM and calendar, with transcripts and call analytics. The product works and a demo is available; we are taking it to market and plan to tailor each deployment to the specific client, so my week is discovery with prospects, scoping what a given customer would actually need, and turning that into what gets built next.

Before this I managed projects for over six years across different business areas. I redesigned client-project processes at U.S. companies — a strictly six-month cycle, new express tracks and a 35% higher success rate — and delivered an investment project of 11 tenders worth RUB 42M on time. I completed an IT project management course through a U.S. Embassy program and am taking the PSM I exam in November 2026.

WHAT I ACTUALLY DO IN PRODUCT

- **Customer discovery, for real.** Our whole go-to-market is discovery-led: every prospective client gets interviewed about their call flows before anything is configured. I have also run several hundred structured client-intake interviews in a previous career — the skill of asking past the stated request is the one I have practiced longest.
- **Scoping a raw product into a shippable one.** Deciding what to build for the client in front of you, what to generalize, and what to refuse is the weekly 0-to-1 judgment call. I make it with engineers, not at them.
- **Requirements engineers can act on.** My rewritten workflows, templates and checklists at M&M became the team default. Writing something precise enough that other people execute it without me is the part of the job I enjoy most.
- **Where conversational products break.** Retrieval that returns the plausible answer instead of the right one, handover to a human, and the gap between what callers actually say and what the happy path assumed. I have hit all three while building and testing the product.
- **Process redesign with measurable results.** At one U.S. company I rebuilt the client-project workflow: the cycle became strictly six months or less, two- and four-month express tracks were introduced, errors decreased, and the share of successful cases rose by 35%.
- **Domain range.** Law, construction, events and retail — I can interview a lawyer, a site manager or a venue producer in their own vocabulary. For a B2B product, the discovery bottleneck is usually the interviewer, not the user.

PRODUCT & INDEPENDENT WORK

Chief Operating Officer — SayWhen.am (AI voice agents for business)

Feb 2026 – present

- Run product development with the CTO in Jira and Confluence and manage the company's corporate clients across the full engagement cycle: discovery, scoping deployments, and feeding what clients ask for back into the roadmap.
- The product handles inbound and outbound calls in **Armenian, Russian and English**, with CRM and knowledge-base integration, calendar booking, live transcripts and call analytics.
- Early stage and pre-scale: the build is working and will be tailored per client, so prioritizing what to generalize is a live weekly decision. Demo available on request.

Independent consultant — legal, research and commercial projects Feb 2026 – present

- Business research for a water production line.
- Corporate structure design for a crypto trader; advised a St. Petersburg entrepreneur on setting up a crypto-exchange operation in Armenia.
- IP assignment for popular musicians' works; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); sale of family real estate; designed a U.S. client-acquisition pilot for **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy).

OPERATING EXPERIENCE

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation (U.S.) Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Owned up to **12 complex client projects at a time**, end to end, against fixed external deadlines.
- Redesigned the delivery process: a cycle of **strictly six months or less**, new **two- and four-month express tracks**, fewer errors through a shared knowledge base, and a **35% higher success rate**.
- Coordinated **8 specialists** and reviewed their work against written acceptance criteria; my templates, checklists and hand-off rules became the team standard.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Live events for **100–3,000** people — concerts, festivals, Miro's corporate conference and a touring TV show — several in parallel, on dates that could not move.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through.

Legal practice — U.S. law firms, Arbitration Court, Bar Association Dec 2019 – Aug 2024

- Senior Paralegal at Shamayev Business Law, Paralegal at Bloomrich Law Firm: built the internal training program **Paralegal Academy** (50+ people) and improved the firms' internal processes.
- Judge's Associate: **200+ concurrent cases, 30+ hearings a week**; earlier, contract analysis and claims work at a Bar Association.

Project Manager — SIS LLC (family business) Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- Managed projects including an **investment project made up of 11 public and private tenders worth RUB 42M** — every site delivered **on time and accepted with no defects noted**.
- Teams of up to 20; procurement, logistics between sites and recruiting; built the first schedules and Gantt charts; set up a regional supply network for the retail business.

SKILLS

- **Product:** customer discovery and interviews · requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria · scoping and prioritization · roadmap input · competitor and market research · metric definition · conversational-AI and RAG fundamentals
- **Delivery:** Scrum and Kanban · scope and timelines · backlog refinement · risk tracking · SOPs, checklists and runbooks · cross-functional coordination · leading teams of up to 20
- **Tools:** Jira · Confluence · Miro · Notion · Trello · Monday · Postman · Google Analytics · amoCRM · Bitrix24 · Google Workspace · Claude Code

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Professional Scrum Master I (Scrum.org)** — exam scheduled for November 2026.
- **Project Management (PM Club)** — 2023, 52 hours.
- **Piscine intensive (C programming)** — 42 Yerevan, Nov–Dec 2025; passed selection and completed it alongside a full-time job.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.